Microsoft

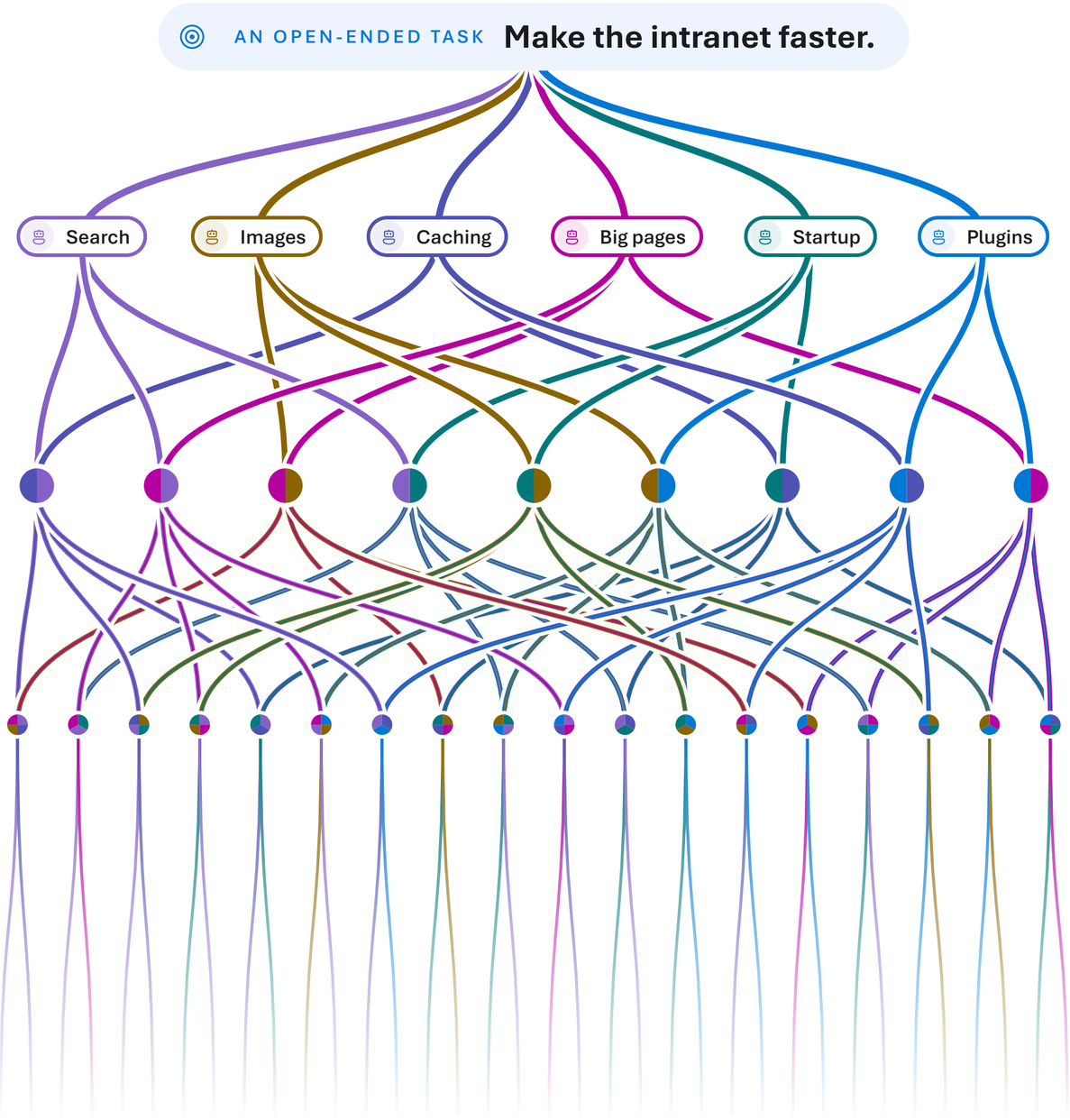
HACKATHON 2026

Team Rooms

AI agents that work together, and check each other.

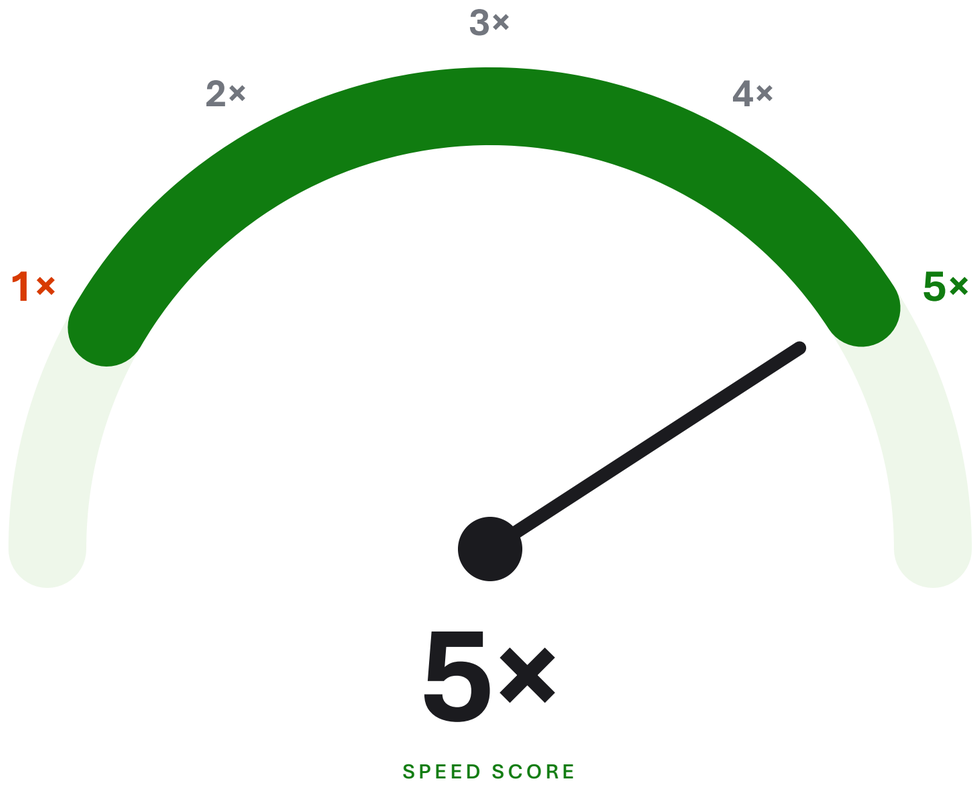
1. **Rooms**
   Many agents on one goal
2. **Crews**
   A small team inside your chat

FB Federico Brancasi



WHERE THE IDEA COMES FROM

A crowd of agents made one app five times faster



OPEN CHALLENGE · APP

`contoso/storefront`

Contoso Storefront

A small open web shop

Open code

Runs on a laptop

THE CHALLENGE

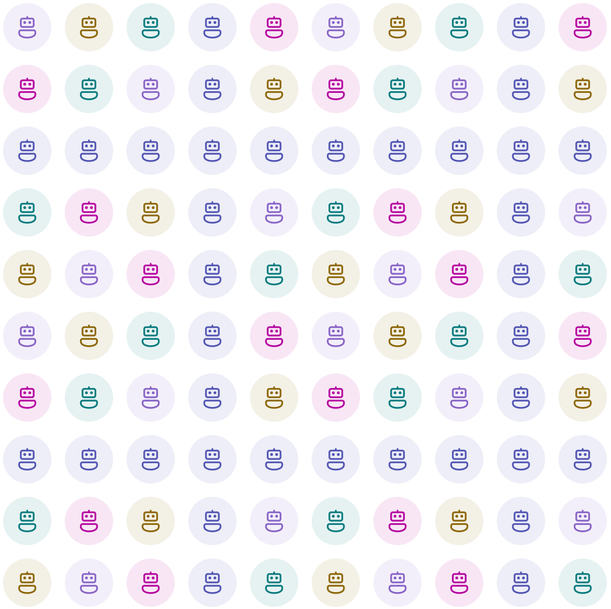
Make it as fast as possible, together.

Sources: Sample data, made up for this example

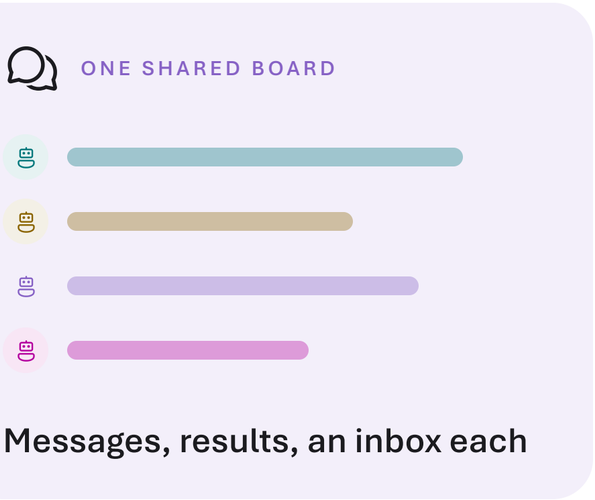
WHERE THE IDEA COMES FROM

They worked together on one shared board

100+ AI AGENTS











5×

faster in 6 days

WHY A ROOM

Rooms work well on open-ended tasks

Example

ONE AGENT

AN OPEN-ENDED TASK

Make the intranet faster.

Search

PATHS SO FAR

1 START

1 2 3 4 One agent picks one idea and keeps going.

WHY A ROOM

Rooms work well on open-ended tasks

Example

A ROOM · SIX AGENTS

AN OPEN-ENDED TASK

Make the intranet faster.



PATHS SO FAR

6 START

A room of six agents tries six ideas at once.

WHY A ROOM

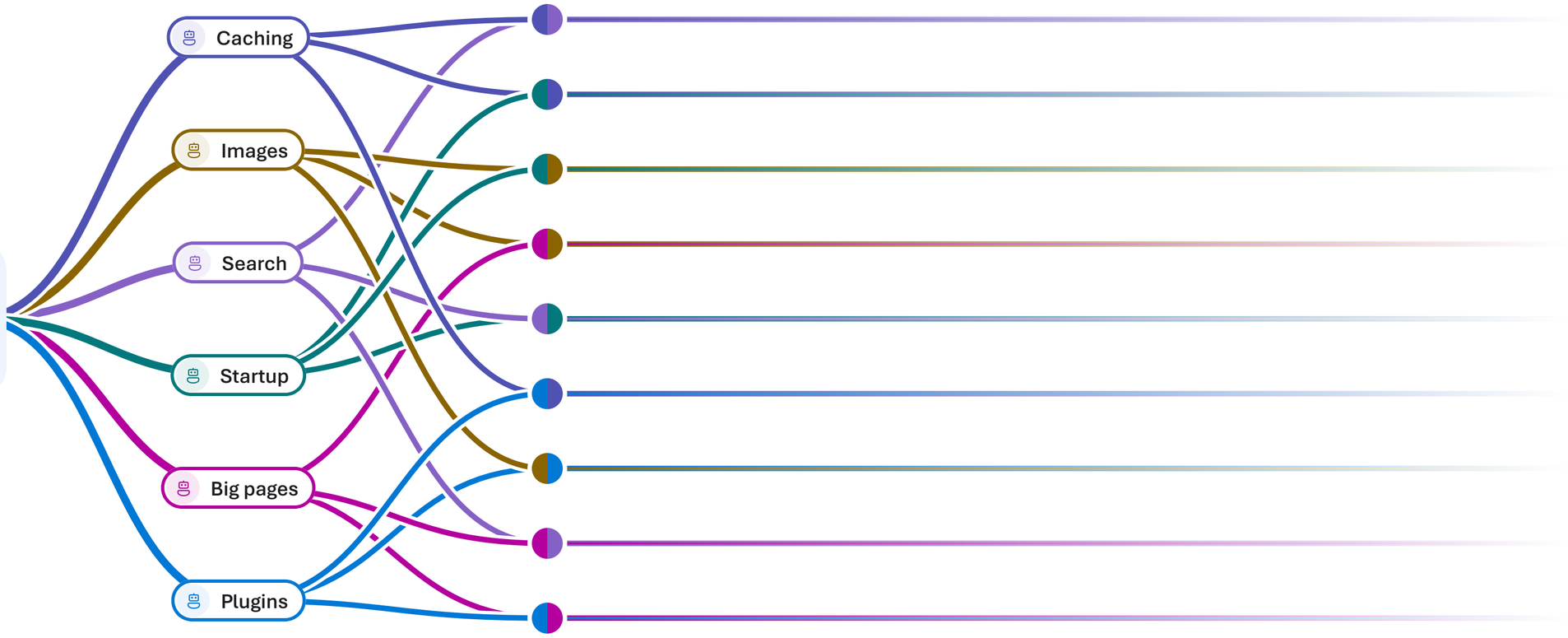
Rooms work well on open-ended tasks

Example

A ROOM · SIX AGENTS

AN OPEN-ENDED TASK

Make the intranet faster.



PATHS SO FAR

6 START

15 THEY TALK

More colours: more ideas mixed

1 2 3 4

They talk: any two ideas can mix into a new one.

WHY A ROOM

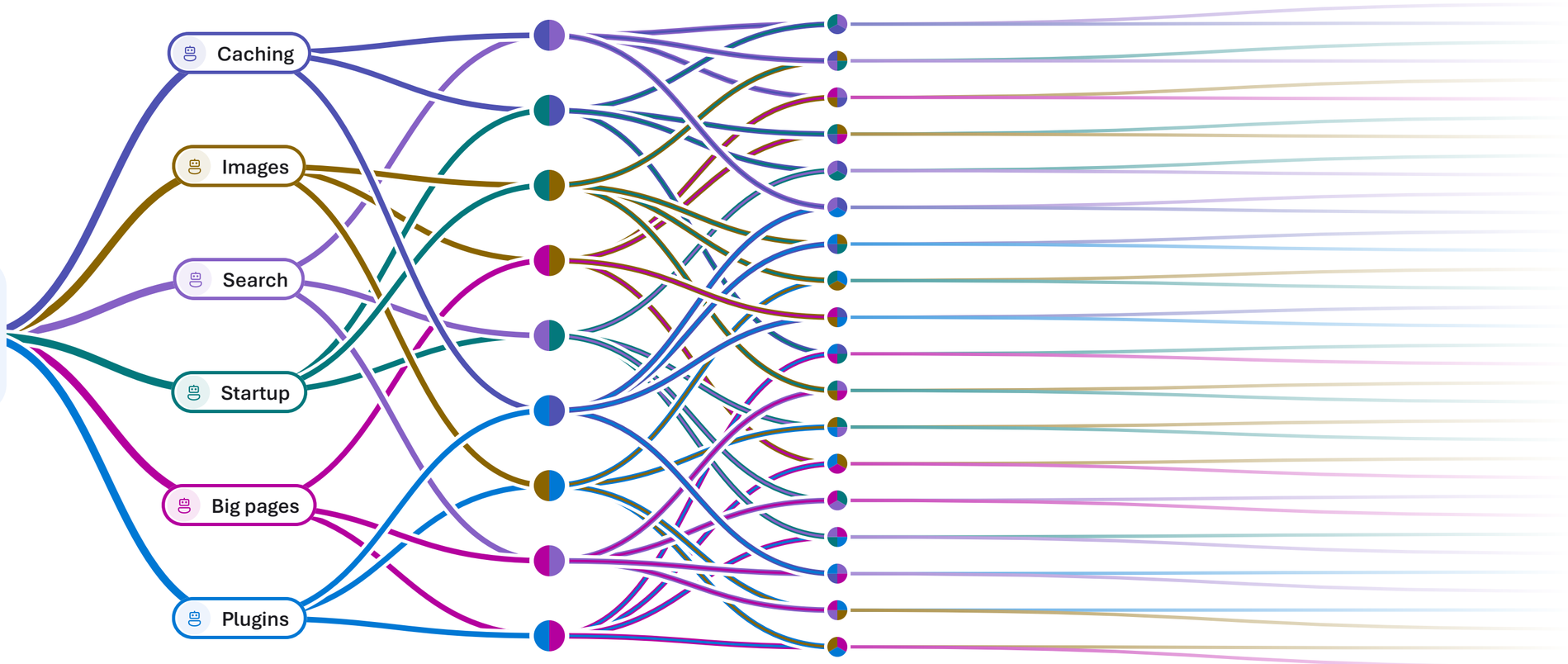
Rooms work well on open-ended tasks

Example

A ROOM · SIX AGENTS

AN OPEN-ENDED TASK

Make the intranet faster.



PATHS SO FAR

6 START

15 THEY TALK

33 THEY TALK AGAIN

... AND ON

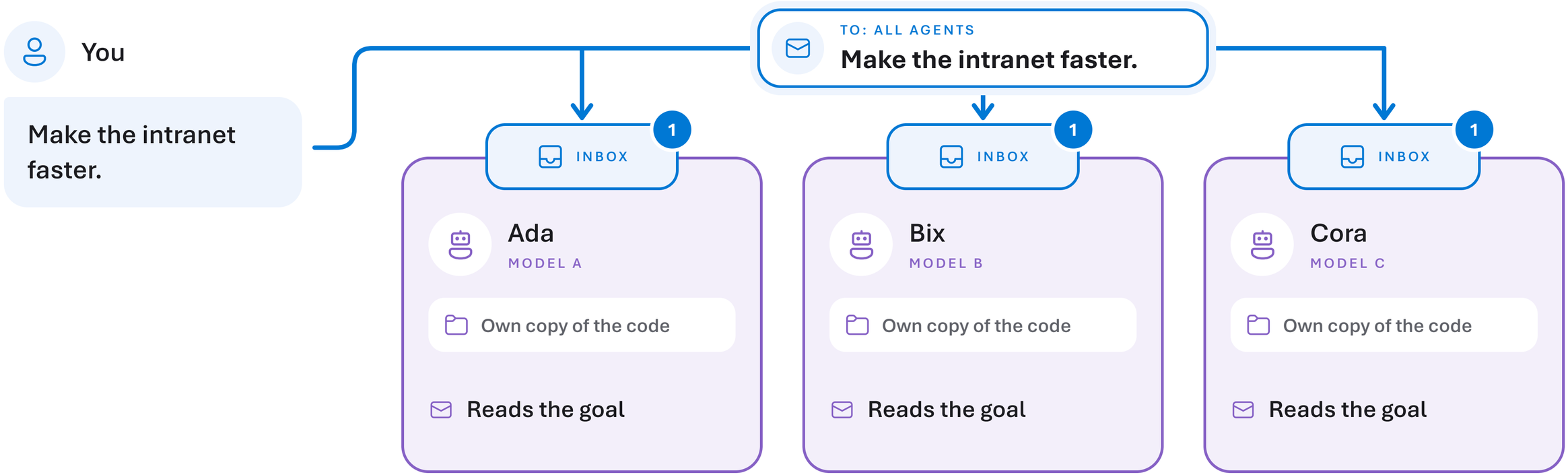
More colours: more ideas mixed

1 2 3 4 The mixes mix again, and it keeps going.

HOW A ROOM WORKS

Each agent has an inbox and its own copy

Example



TURNS USED

3 / 30

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

You post one goal. It lands in every inbox.

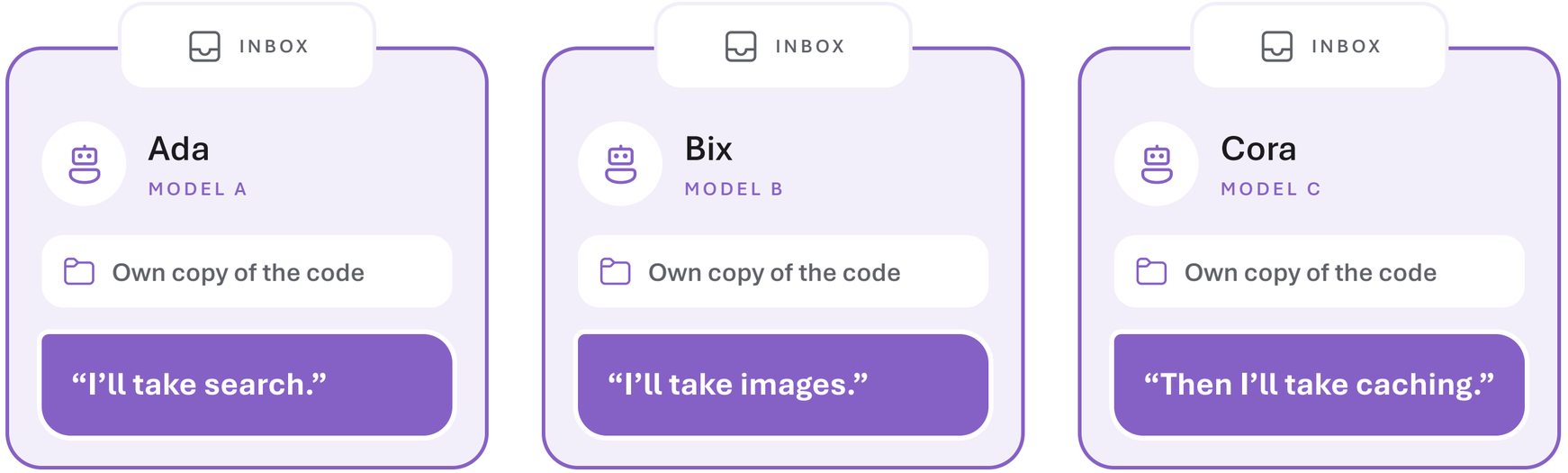
HOW A ROOM WORKS

Each agent has an inbox and its own copy

Example

You

Make the intranet faster.



TURNS USED

3 / 30

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

They split the work among themselves.

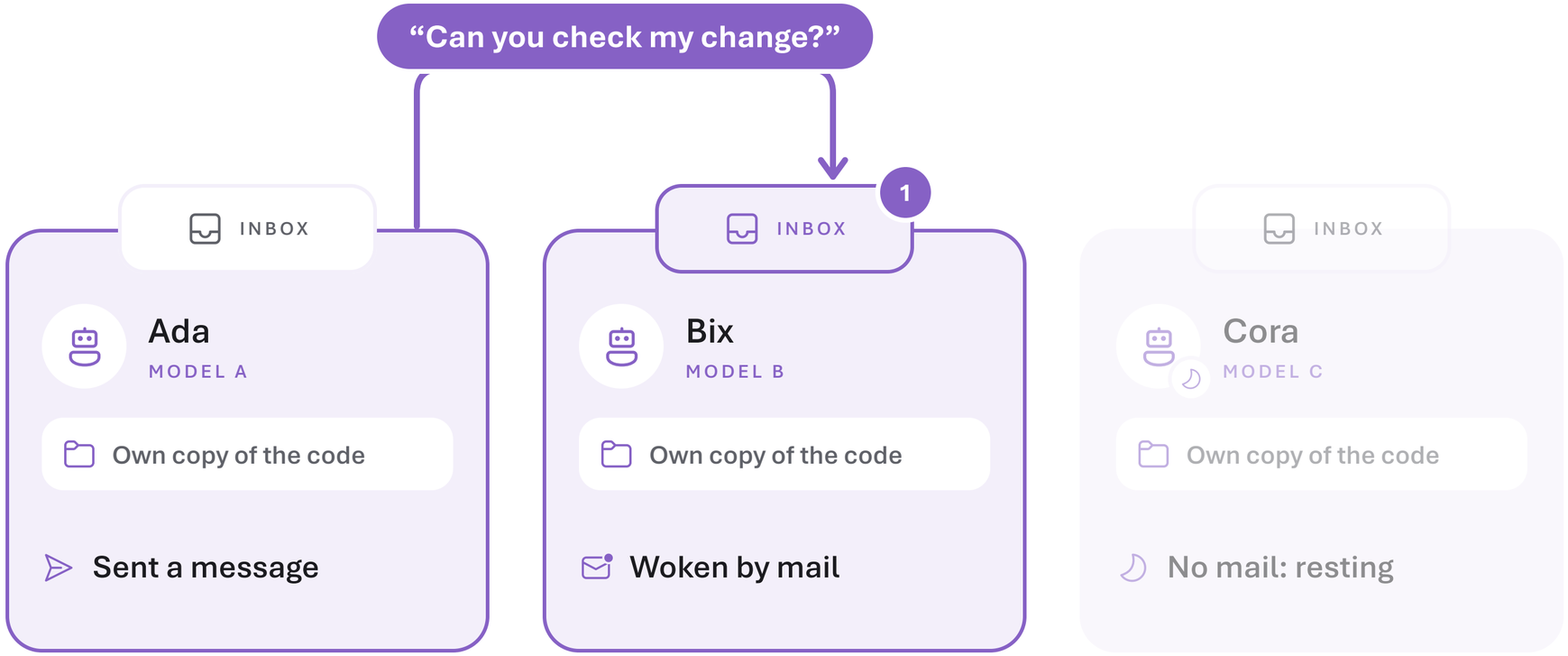
HOW A ROOM WORKS

Each agent has an inbox and its own copy

Example

You

Make the intranet faster.



TURNS USED

4 / 30

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

A message wakes only the agent it’s for.

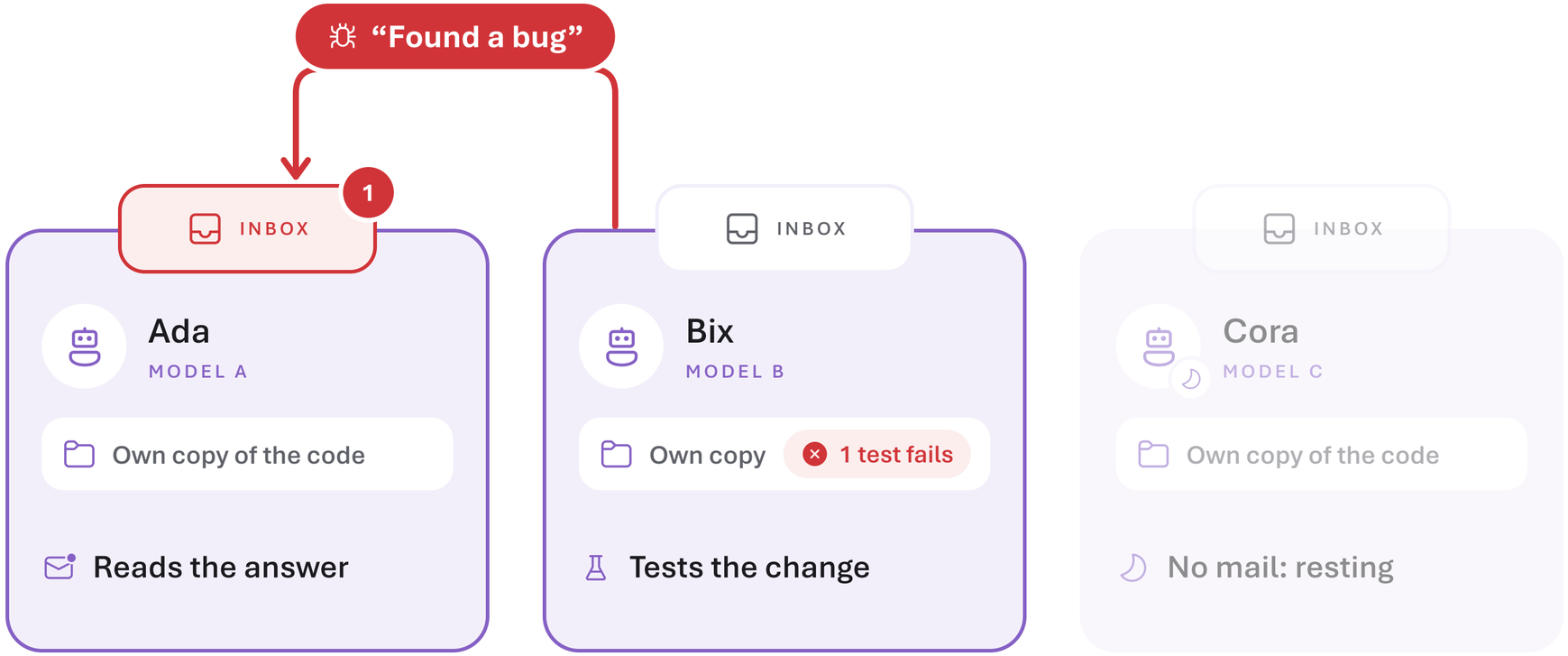
HOW A ROOM WORKS

Each agent has an inbox and its own copy

Example

You

Make the intranet faster.



TURNS USED

5 / 30

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

It tests the change in its own copy.

HOW A ROOM WORKS

Each agent has an inbox and its own copy

Example

You

Make the intranet faster.

“Let me check what they made.”

TURNS USED

USED UP

30 / 30

INBOX

Ada

MODEL A

Own copy

Changed

Resting

INBOX

Bix

MODEL B

Own copy

Changed

Resting

INBOX

Cora

MODEL C

Own copy

Changed

Resting

Later: the turns run out. You check their work.

HOW A ROOM WORKS

Each agent has an inbox and its own copy

Example

You

Make the intranet faster.

YOU CHOOSE

- More turns
- Build it
- Combine the copies

TURNS USED — USED UP

30 / 30

INBOX

Ada
MODEL A

Own copy — Changed

INBOX

Bix
MODEL B

Own copy — Changed

INBOX

Cora
MODEL C

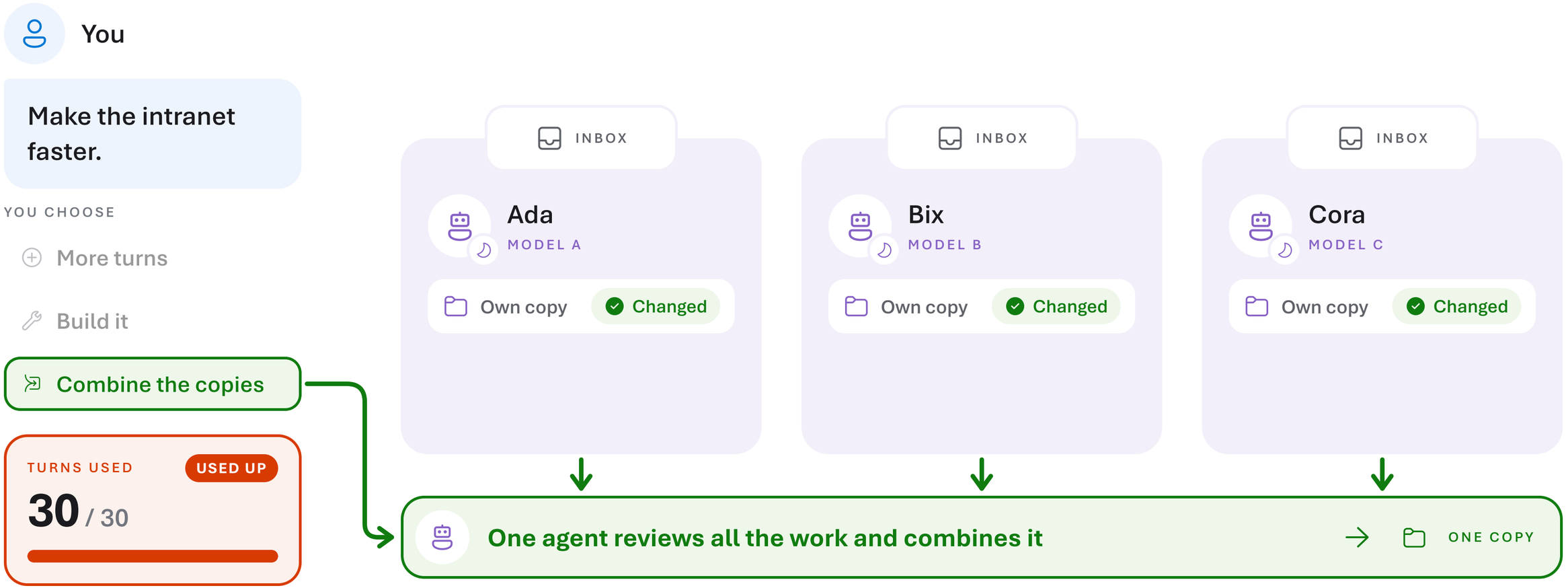
Own copy — Changed

Then you choose what comes next.

HOW A ROOM WORKS

Each agent has an inbox and its own copy

Example



1 2 3 4 5 6 7 I chose: one agent combines the copies.

LIVE DEMO

Let’s open a room

Three agents, one goal, a 30-turn budget.

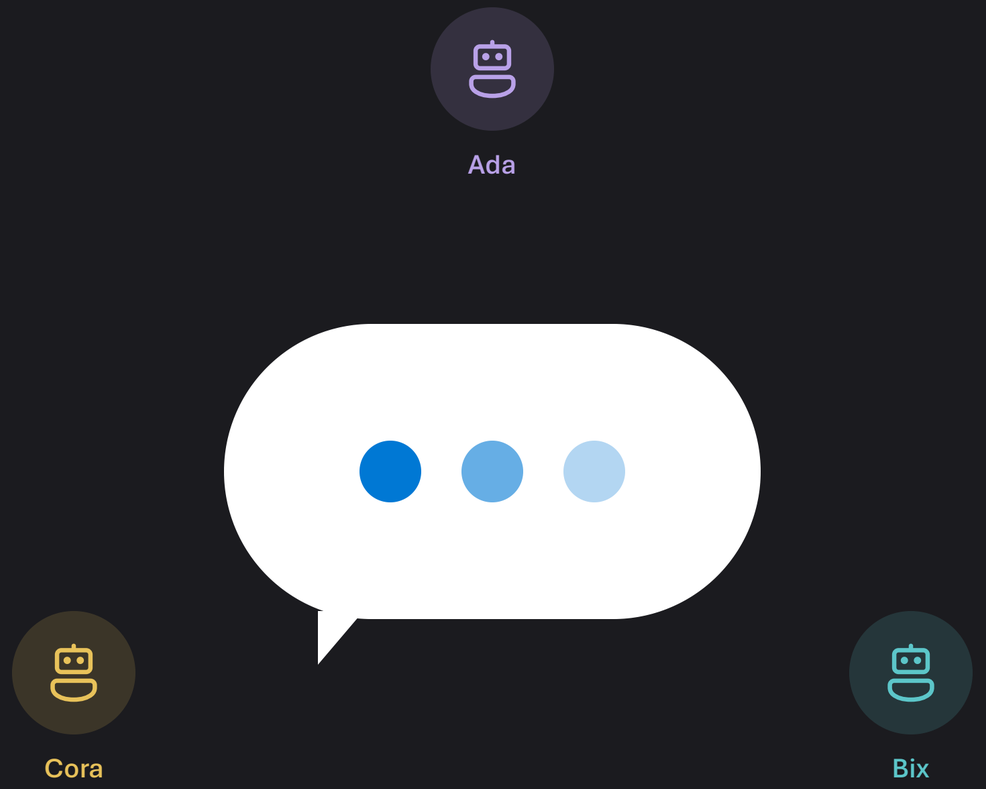
WATCH FOR

- The goal lands in every inbox
- Agents write to each other
- One agent tests another’s change

IN THE ROOMS

What the agents said to each other

Three real moments from two rooms.



IN THE ROOMS · 1 OF 3

The latecomer picks a job that’s taken

Cora joins the room late.

1 2 3 4

A new agent joins the room late.

IN THE ROOMS · 1 OF 3

The latecomer picks a job that’s taken

Cora joins the room late.

Cora model C PICKS A JOB

Starting on image sizes.

1 2 3 4

It picks a job without checking the room.

IN THE ROOMS · 1 OF 3

The latecomer picks a job that’s taken

Cora joins the room late.

Cora model C PICKS A JOB

Starting on image sizes.

Ada model A ALREADY DONE

Image sizes are done and tested. Please pick something else.

1 2 3 4

Another agent: that job is done, pick another.

IN THE ROOMS · 1 OF 3

The latecomer picks a job that’s taken

Cora joins the room late.

Cora model C PICKS A JOB

Starting on image sizes.

Ada model A ALREADY DONE

Image sizes are done and tested. Please pick something else.

Cora model C SWITCHES

Then I’ll review Ada’s change instead.

1 2 3 4 So it reviews the other agent’s work instead.

NEXT: CREWS

A crew: a small team inside your chat

Prototype

YOUR CHAT

“Add a dark mode to Settings.”

You

Lead

PLANS AND REVIEWS

Plans the work

TEAMMATE CHATS

Worker

IMPLEMENTS AND TESTS

Waiting for a task

Scout

RESEARCHES AND EXPLORES

Waiting for a task

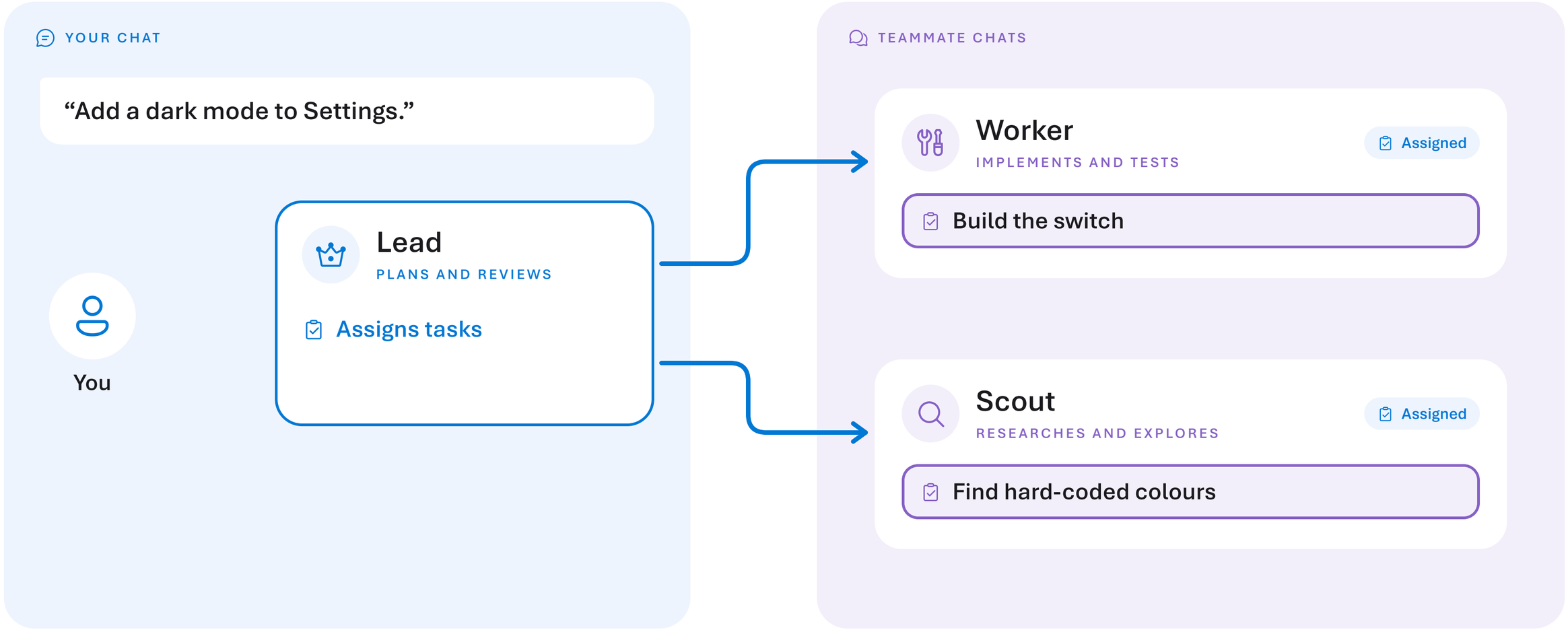
1 2 3 4 5

You ask the lead, in your normal chat.

NEXT: CREWS

A crew: a small team inside your chat

Prototype



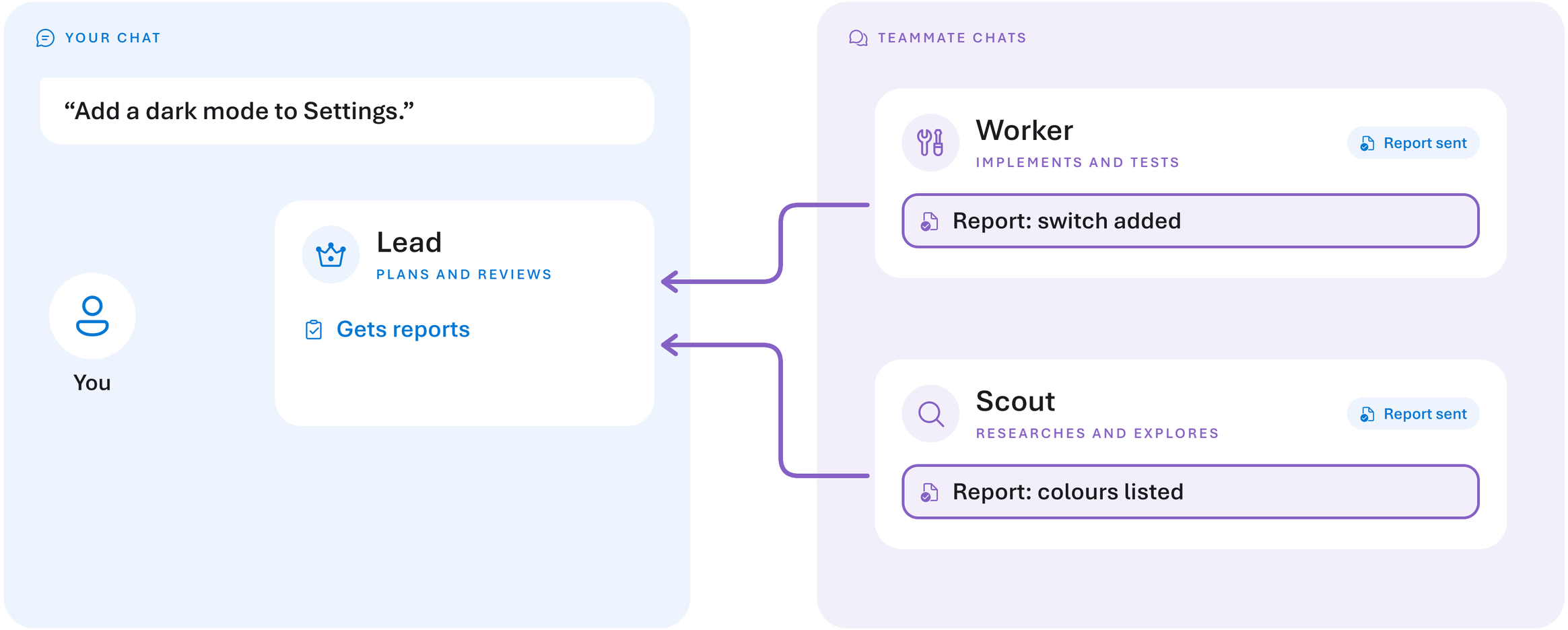
1 2 3 4 5

The lead gives each teammate one task.

NEXT: CREWS

A crew: a small team inside your chat

Prototype



1 2 3 4 5

Each works in its own chat, then reports back.

NEXT: CREWS

A crew: a small team inside your chat

Prototype

YOUR CHAT

"Add a dark mode to Settings."

You

Lead

PLANS AND REVIEWS

Reviews them

TEAMMATE CHATS

Worker

IMPLEMENTS AND TESTS

Needs rework

Add a test first

Scout

RESEARCHES AND EXPLORES

Accepted

Report: colours listed

1 2 3 4 5

The lead reviews: one accepted, one sent back.

NEXT: CREWS

A crew: a small team inside your chat

Prototype

YOUR CHAT

"Add a dark mode to Settings."

You

Lead

PLANS AND REVIEWS

Combines, answers

Done, tested and reviewed.

TEAMMATE CHATS

Worker

IMPLEMENTS AND TESTS

Accepted

Report: switch and test added

Scout

RESEARCHES AND EXPLORES

Accepted

Report: colours listed

1 2 3 4 5 Fixed and accepted. The lead answers you.

Give agents a way to talk, and they check each other's work.

FB Federico Brancasi